

SANDER VANWILLIGEN

LEAD DATA ENGINEER

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Last seen: Polk City, Iowa

You are traveling through another dataset, a dataset not only of rows and columns but of meaning. A journey into a relational lake whose boundaries are that of imagination. That's the dashboard up ahead - your next stop, the Data Zone!

THE DATA ZONE

ENGINDEX ENTRY

DEX No.010

TYPE

Lead Data Engineer · 2026–Now

EVOLUTION

Contractor '16 › Developer '18 › Software Engineer '20 › Senior SWE '24 › Lead Data Engineer '26

PRIMARY HABITAT

Pharmacists Mutual Insurance

YEARS ACTIVE

10

ABILITIES

End-to-End ETL Ingestion

Medallion / Kimball Modelling

Cloud Lakehouse Migration

Git + CI/CD

Enterprise Analytics

Master Data Management

C-Suite Communication

Data Leadership & Strategy

AI / LLM Adoption

WEAKNESSES

Ground

Psychic

Ghost

Dark

super-effective against me

◆ TOOL TAKES

dbt / Dagster / Terraform
Engineer's Ice Cream: vanilla, chocolate, strawberry. I like Neapolitan.

Claude Code
Love it, when I'm not rewriting the mistakes.

Hermes / OpenCode / OpenRouter / Ollama
Claude's neat and all, but I don't want to be dependent.

Git
Like a code-change daily multivitamin.

TypeScript
Boilerplate-ey, but Anders Hejlsberg's accent makes up for it.

Python
Should have gone with a fish name, 'Halibut' or 'Lungfish'.

SQL
Data lingua franca.

MongoDB / NoSQL
Semi-structured is fine, I just wouldn't trust it with my kid's peanut allergy.

Azure / Fabric / Power BI / SQL Server
The day job. "Love what you do"... I've worked a lot of days.

◆ BIG NUMBERS in little data

28 DASHBOARDS
Power BI reports across leadership, built and maintained for 6 years.

5 MONTHS
Rebuilt the entire Enterprise Analytics Platform, with new Ataccama MDM.

7 SEC, NOT 8 HRS
New analytics processes every historical policy-retention KPI.

10 YEARS
Maintaining a daily Java OFAC compliance cron job.

3 DAYS, NOT 3 MONTHS
A data engineer I trained shipped a Worker's Comp export with Claude Code.

60% LESS PROCESSING
Realized right after the enterprise analytics rebuild.

4,700+ WORKS
Speculative public-domain fiction in the [Gutenberg-Fingerprint](#) archive.

◆ A BRIEF HISTORY of victories & casualties

- Aug 2026 Launch of Claude Code**
Company-historic agentic-AI campaign across an enterprise-wide field of battle. Our van ran the evaluation while the rear guard set a security doctrine - data guardrails, approval gates, a custom Warehouse SQL MCP - clearing supply lines, enabling Claude Code in production, and drilling the ranks in its use.
- Jul 2026 Capture of Gutenberg**
Conquered ~4,700 works of public-domain fiction via a nightly stylometrics pipeline - Postgres, Python, dbt, and Dagster. A daring solo mission on a single \$5-a-month VPS - sneaking change-data-capture in, sneaking published dashboards out.
- Jan 2026 Mastering of Data Management**
Selected and enthroned Ataccama as the realm's sovereign of all mastered data. Every ingestion path reports through MDM and a Data Quality advisor, so all analytics decisions come to a single trusted voice.
- 2025 Fall of the Old Analytics**
Razed the legacy vendor's black-box fortress and rebuilt enterprise analytics from the ashes - documented SSIS, SQL, and Tabular models. Storage dropped 50%, processing 60%; a bridge that once took eight hours to lower now opens in 7 seconds.
- 2023 BI Takeover**
Seized full captaincy of the enterprise ETL, SQL architecture, and Tabular reporting stack, and hand-forged the 28 Power BI swords given to the kings and queens of leadership - the intelligence layer, in-house for all of time.
- 2020 Death of iPartners**
Our ancient master, a reporting vendor, perished and took its platform to the tomb. After little grief, the first stones were laid of the internal ETL and reporting architecture that would replace it.
- 2017 The Hand that Shook Paymentus**
A young developer forged an alliance with Paymentus - his Java integration opened a road for automated payments and paperless billing. The magi spoke of it as early proof this developer could carry the enterprise to the outside world.

◆ PULL REQUEST



feat(education): **B.S. in Software Engineering**

sandervw merged 1 commit into `main` from `iowa-state:bs-software-engineering` · Dec 2017

- ✓ Bachelor of Science, Software Engineering · Iowa State University
- ✓ 5 Dean's List buffs: Fall '13, Spring '14, Spring '15, Fall '15, Spring '16